

Corporate Security Policy

Physical access control & clean desk standards

Purpose & Scope

This policy establishes physical security standards to protect Acme Corp employees, visitors, and confidential information on company premises. It applies to all employees, contractors, and visitors, and supports the company's broader information security objectives by controlling physical access to sensitive areas and materials.

Definitions

ID Badge	The official company-issued badge that identifies an individual and grants scanned access to premises.
Tailgating	Following another employee through a secure gate or door without independently scanning a badge.
Escort	A badge-holding employee responsible for accompanying a visitor for the duration of their time on premises.
Clean Desk	The practice of clearing sensitive material from a workspace whenever it is unattended.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Wear ID badge visibly, scan at every access point, and maintain a clean desk at day's end.
Security Team	Monitor entry points, respond to reported tailgating, and manage badge deactivation.
Reception	Sign in all visitors and confirm an escort is assigned before granting building access.
Facilities	Maintain functioning turnstiles, locks, and shredding services across office locations.

1. Physical Access Control & ID Badges

All employees, contractors, and visitors must wear official company ID badges visibly at all times while on company premises. Employees must scan their badges at entry turnstiles.

Visible badge display allows security staff and colleagues to quickly identify anyone in a restricted area and confirms that access was granted through an authorized, logged process rather than informally.

- Tailgating — following another employee through a secure gate without scanning — is treated as a serious security violation, regardless of familiarity with the person being followed.
- Visitors must sign in at reception and remain escorted by a badge holder for the duration of their visit.
- Lost or stolen badges must be reported to Security immediately so access can be deactivated.

■ Zero Tolerance

Tailgating compromises the integrity of access logs and physical security controls and will be treated as a serious violation regardless of intent. Employees should politely ask anyone following them without a scan to use their own badge.

2. Clean Desk Policy

To protect confidential information, employees must clear their desks of all sensitive papers, documents, notes, and physical storage devices (such as USBs) at the end of each workday.

A clean desk reduces the risk of confidential information being viewed, photographed, or removed by anyone who should not have access to it, including after-hours cleaning staff or visitors passing through the office.

- Computer screens must be locked when leaving the desk for any duration, using the Windows + L shortcut.
- File cabinets containing private records must remain locked at all times when unattended.
- Printed material containing personal, financial, or confidential business information should be shredded rather than placed in general waste.

Standard Procedure — Hosting a Visitor

- 1 Notify reception in advance with the visitor's name and arrival time where possible.
- 2 Meet the visitor at reception once they have signed in.
- 3 Ensure the visitor is issued a visitor badge before proceeding past reception.
- 4 Remain with the visitor as their escort for the duration of their time on premises.
- 5 Sign the visitor out at reception and confirm the visitor badge is returned before they leave.

Frequently Asked Questions

What should I do if I see someone tailgating?

Politely ask the individual to scan their own badge, and report the incident to Security if the behavior is repeated or the person is unfamiliar.

Do I need to lock my screen for a quick trip to the printer?

Yes. Screens must be locked for any duration away from the desk, regardless of how brief.

Can a visitor move around the office unescorted after signing in?

No. Visitors must remain with their assigned badge-holding escort for the entire visit.

What do I do with printed documents I no longer need?

Confidential or personal information should be shredded rather than placed in general waste bins.

Non-Compliance & Enforcement

Confirmed tailgating incidents and repeated clean desk violations are logged by Security and may be escalated to the employee's manager. Serious or repeated violations will be addressed through Acme Corp's standard disciplinary process, consistent with the company's information security obligations.

Example Scenarios

Scenario: A colleague without their badge

An employee arrives at the turnstile and notices a colleague behind them without a visible badge, asking to be let in. Following policy, the employee asks the colleague to scan their own badge or check in with reception rather than allowing them to tailgate through.

Scenario: Stepping away for a meeting

An employee leaves sensitive contract documents on their desk to attend a 30-minute meeting. Before leaving, they lock their screen with Windows + L and place the documents in a locked drawer, in line with the clean desk requirement.

Scenario: Hosting an external vendor

An employee expects a vendor for a 2:00 PM meeting. They notify reception in advance, meet the vendor after sign-in, and escort them for the full duration of the visit before signing them out at reception.

Related Policies & Resources

- Information Security Policy — safeguarding of digital and physical confidential data
- Visitor Management Guidelines — detailed reception and escort procedures
- Incident Reporting Procedure — how to report security violations or concerns

Quick Reference — Security Policy

Item	Policy
ID badge display	Worn visibly at all times on premises
Badge scanning	Required at every entry turnstile
Tailgating	Serious security violation — zero tolerance
Visitor access	Sign in at reception; escorted by badge holder
End-of-day desk	Cleared of sensitive papers, documents, USBs
Screen lock	Windows + L whenever leaving desk, any duration
File cabinets	Locked at all times when containing private records

Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Changes
1.0	July 13, 2026	Initial consolidated publication of the Security policy for the Enterprise Policy Assistant.

This document is the authoritative source for this policy area. In the event of any discrepancy with summaries, training materials, or third-party references, this policy document takes precedence. Questions not addressed here should be directed to the relevant owning department listed under Roles & Responsibilities.